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THURSDAY FEBRUARY 6, 2025
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DXB creates new post to keep flyers happy

DUBAI
BY SHARMILA DHAL
UAE Editor

Dubai International (DXB) announced last week that 92.3 million guests passed through its terminals in 2024, making it the world's busiest airport for the 10th consecutive year. It is perhaps safe to say these passengers are the happiest too.

That, now, is no happenstance. It is a reflection of the innovative mindset of those at the helm that keeps DXB ahead of the game.

One such shift in thinking has been the creation of the post of a Chief People's Officer (CPO), whose responsibility is to ensure that those serving DXB's guests feel valued, engaged and empowered enough to create exceptional experiences expected from the best airport in the world.

Meshari Al Bannai, Dubai Airport's first CPO, who came up with the concept behind the title, spoke to *Gulf News* in an exclusive interview to explain how his responsibility is distinct from the traditional HR role, and how in a complex environment like DXB, success lies in aligning its many stakeholders with one vision.

"It's a case of 'Many Hearts, One Beat'," he said.

FULL INTERVIEW ON P3

World rejects Trump's Gaza takeover, relocation plans

UAE CATEGORICALLY OPPOSES ANY ATTEMPTS TO DISPLACE PALESTINIANS

DUBAI
BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

US President Donald Trump's proposal for the United States to seize control of Gaza and expel its population has been met with swift and overwhelming rejection from Palestinians, Middle Eastern leaders and global powers.

The UAE affirmed its commitment to safeguard the rights of Palestinians.

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MoFA) stressed its categorical rejection of any infringement on the Palestinians' unalienable rights, and any attempts of displacement, and reaffirmed the importance of halting any settlement activities which threaten regional stability and undermine the opportunities for peace and co-existence.

Furious response

Saudi Arabia also slammed the idea as an "infringement on Palestinian rights," while the Arab League declared it a "blatant violation of international law" and a "recipe for instability."

The UN human rights chief warned that any forcible population transfer would be strictly prohibited under international law.

Saudi Arabia also reiterated that it will not establish diplomatic ties with Israel unless an



AFF

■ An activist dressed as the Statue of Liberty is pulled in shackles as people rally in support of Palestinians during a protest near the White House in Washington DC, on Tuesday.

independent Palestinian state is recognised.

Trump's remarks, made alongside Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu during a White House press conference, sparked a furious backlash.

Palestinian President Mahmoud Abbas, as well as leaders from Egypt, Turkey, Britain, France, Germany, and China, forcefully denounced the plan.

Trump claimed his proposal had support from "the highest leadership" in the Middle East

but provided no details on how the forced removal of over two million Palestinians would be executed. He suggested the US could "take over" Gaza, clear unexploded bombs and rubble, and turn the war-ravaged strip into the "Riviera of the Middle East." "The US will take over the Gaza Strip. We'll own it," Trump declared. "We will dismantle all dangerous weapons and make it unbelievable."

In recent days, Trump has cited Egypt and Jordan as possi-

ble destinations, but people from the territory have said they want to stay. "Trump thinks Gaza is a pile of garbage — absolutely not," 34-year-old Hatem Azzam, a resident of the territory, told AFP new agency.

For Palestinians, any attempts to force them out of Gaza would evoke dark memories of what the Arab world calls the "Nakba", or catastrophe — the mass displacement of Palestinians during Israel's creation in 1948.

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